

10 RECIPES

Emulsified Body Scrub Recipes

Part of the 200+ DIY Body Care Recipes Bundle. Photo shown is a representative example for this category, not every individual recipe.



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Vanilla Sugar Emulsified Scrub

Active time 10 min active, no cook time

Batch size about 8 oz (225 g)

Ingredients

INGREDIENT	AMOUNT
Emulsifying wax NF	15 g (0.5 oz)
Sweet almond oil	60 g (2.1 oz)
Distilled water	40 g (1.4 oz)
White granulated sugar	100 g (3.5 oz)
Broad-spectrum preservative (e.g. a liquid preservative rated for water-containing scrubs, used at the rate its own label states)	per label — typically 0.5-1 g
Vanilla fragrance oil	3 g (about 1/2 tsp)

Method

- 1 Melt the emulsifying wax and almond oil together in a double boiler until clear.
- 2 In a separate cup, warm the distilled water to about the same temperature as the oil mixture (check with a thermometer, aim for 160-170°F / 70-77°C on both).
- 3 Pour the warm water into the oil mixture in a thin stream, stirring constantly, until it turns opaque and creamy — this is the emulsion forming.
- 4 Let it cool to under 110°F (43°C), checking with a thermometer — adding the preservative while too hot can break it down.
- 5 Stir in the preservative at the exact rate its label specifies, then the fragrance oil.
- 6 Fold in the sugar last, once the mixture is thick enough that the sugar won't sink to the bottom.

7

Spoon into a jar and label with the date made.

Shelf life

This recipe includes water, so it needs a broad-spectrum preservative (see ingredients) and lasts about 3 months at room temperature, away from the shower's direct spray. Without the preservative it can grow mold or bacteria within days — never skip it.

Tips

- Always add the preservative after cooling, at the manufacturer's stated rate — more isn't safer, it just follows what was tested to work.
- If the sugar dissolves instead of staying gritty, your mixture was too hot when you added it — let it cool further next time.

Before you make this

This scrub contains water and must be preserved correctly, used within its stated shelf life, and kept out of reach of children. Discontinue if it changes smell, color or texture.

Brown Sugar Vanilla Bean Emulsified Scrub

Active time 15 min active, no cook time

Batch size about 8 oz (225 g)

Ingredients

INGREDIENT	AMOUNT
Emulsifying wax NF	15 g (0.5 oz)
Sweet almond oil	60 g (2.1 oz)
Distilled water	40 g (1.4 oz)
Light brown sugar	100 g (3.5 oz)
Broad-spectrum preservative (a liquid preservative rated for water-containing scrubs, used at the rate its own label states)	per label — typically 0.5-1 g
Vanilla bean fragrance oil (or the scraped seeds of 1 vanilla bean for flecks)	3 g (about 1/2 tsp)

Method

- 1 Set up a double boiler: a heatproof bowl over a pot with 1-2 in (2-3 cm) of simmering water, bowl not touching the water.
- 2 Melt the emulsifying wax and almond oil together, stirring, until fully clear (about 5 min).
- 3 In a separate cup, warm the distilled water to roughly the same temperature as the oil (aim for 160-170°F / 70-77°C on both, checked with a thermometer).
- 4 Pour the warm water into the oil mixture in a thin stream, stirring constantly, until it turns opaque and creamy.
- 5 Let it cool to under 110°F (43°C) before continuing — adding the preservative while too hot can break it down.

- 6 Stir in the preservative at the exact rate its label specifies, then the vanilla fragrance oil.
- 7 Fold in the brown sugar once the base is thick enough that the sugar won't sink.
- 8 Spoon into a jar and label with the date made.

Shelf life

3 months at room temperature, needs a preservative. This recipe contains water, so it needs a broad-spectrum preservative (see ingredients). Without the correct preservative at the correct dose, a water-containing scrub like this can grow mold or bacteria within days — never skip it or substitute it with vitamin E, which is an antioxidant, not a preservative.

Tips

- Brown sugar holds more moisture than white sugar, so the scrub will look slightly wetter at first — it firms up as it fully cools.
- Always add the preservative after cooling, at the rate its own label states; more is not safer, it just follows what was tested to work.

Before you make this

This scrub contains water and must be preserved correctly, used within its stated shelf life, and kept out of reach of children. Discontinue use if it changes smell, color or texture.

French Rose Clay Emulsified Scrub

Active time 15 min active, no cook time

Batch size about 8 oz (225 g)

Ingredients

INGREDIENT	AMOUNT
Emulsifying wax NF	15 g (0.5 oz)
Jojoba oil	60 g (2.1 oz)
Distilled water	40 g (1.4 oz)
White granulated sugar	90 g (3.2 oz)
French rose clay (or pink kaolin clay)	10 g (0.35 oz)
Broad-spectrum preservative (per its own label)	per label — typically 0.5-1 g
Rose geranium essential oil	15 drops

Method

- 1 Set up a double boiler and melt the emulsifying wax and jojoba oil together until clear (about 5 min).
- 2 Warm the distilled water separately to about the same temperature (160-170°F / 70-77°C).
- 3 Pour the warm water into the oil mixture in a thin stream, stirring constantly, until creamy and opaque.
- 4 Cool the base to under 110°F (43°C), checking with a thermometer.
- 5 Stir in the preservative at the label's stated rate, then the rose geranium essential oil.
- 6 Sprinkle in the rose clay and whisk until the color is even, with no dry pockets.

7 Fold in the sugar once the base is thick enough to suspend it.

8 Spoon into a jar and label with the date made.

Shelf life

3 months at room temperature, needs a preservative. This recipe contains water, so it needs a broad-spectrum preservative (see ingredients). Without the correct preservative at the correct dose, it can grow mold or bacteria within days — never skip it.

Tips

- Add the clay a little at a time and whisk well — it clumps fast if dumped in all at once.
- Stir the jar's contents before each use if the clay settles toward the bottom over time.

Before you make this

This scrub contains water and must be preserved correctly, used within its stated shelf life, and kept out of reach of children. Discontinue use if it changes smell, color or texture.

Coconut Lime Emulsified Scrub

Active time 15 min active, no cook time

Batch size about 8 oz (225 g)

Ingredients

INGREDIENT	AMOUNT
Emulsifying wax NF	15 g (0.5 oz)
Fractionated coconut oil	60 g (2.1 oz)
Distilled water	40 g (1.4 oz)
White granulated sugar	100 g (3.5 oz)
Broad-spectrum preservative (per its own label)	per label — typically 0.5-1 g
Coconut fragrance oil	2 g (about 1/3 tsp)
Steam-distilled lime essential oil (not cold-pressed, which is phototoxic)	10 drops

Method

- 1 Set up a double boiler and melt the emulsifying wax and coconut oil together until clear (about 5 min).
- 2 Warm the distilled water separately to about 160-170°F (70-77°C).
- 3 Pour the warm water into the oil mixture in a thin stream, stirring constantly, until creamy.
- 4 Cool the base to under 110°F (43°C).
- 5 Stir in the preservative at the label's stated rate, then the coconut fragrance oil and lime essential oil.
- 6 Fold in the sugar once the base is thick enough to hold it.

7

Spoon into a jar and label with the date made.

Shelf life

3 months at room temperature, needs a preservative. This recipe contains water, so it needs a broad-spectrum preservative (see ingredients). Without the correct preservative at the correct dose, it can grow mold or bacteria within days — never skip it.

Tips

- Use steam-distilled lime, not cold-pressed — cold-pressed citrus oils can make skin more sensitive to sunburn.
- If the scent fades fast, fragrance and essential oils can evaporate a little in the warm pour — add them right after cooling, not before.

Before you make this

This scrub contains water and must be preserved correctly, used within its stated shelf life, and kept out of reach of children. Discontinue use if it changes smell, color or texture.

Honey Oat Emulsified Scrub

Active time 15 min active, no cook time

Batch size about 8 oz (225 g)

Ingredients

INGREDIENT	AMOUNT
Emulsifying wax NF	15 g (0.5 oz)
Sweet almond oil	55 g (1.9 oz)
Distilled water	40 g (1.4 oz)
White granulated sugar	70 g (2.5 oz)
Finely ground colloidal oatmeal	20 g (0.7 oz)
Broad-spectrum preservative (per its own label)	per label — typically 0.5-1 g
Honey fragrance oil (skin-safe cosmetic fragrance, not raw honey)	2 g (about 1/3 tsp)

Method

- 1 Set up a double boiler and melt the emulsifying wax and almond oil together until clear (about 5 min).
- 2 Warm the distilled water separately to about 160-170°F (70-77°C).
- 3 Pour the warm water into the oil mixture in a thin stream, stirring constantly, until creamy.
- 4 Cool the base to under 110°F (43°C).
- 5 Stir in the preservative at the label's stated rate, then the honey fragrance oil.
- 6 Fold in the sugar and ground oatmeal once the base is thick enough to hold them.

7

Spoon into a jar and label with the date made.

Shelf life

3 months at room temperature, needs a preservative. This recipe contains water, so it needs a broad-spectrum preservative (see ingredients). Without the correct preservative at the correct dose, it can grow mold or bacteria within days — never skip it.

Tips

- Grind the oatmeal fine (a coffee grinder works well) — whole oats feel scratchy instead of gently exfoliating.
- This is a softer, gentler scrub than straight sugar — a good one to reach for on sensitive or dry skin.

Before you make this

This scrub contains water and must be preserved correctly, used within its stated shelf life, and kept out of reach of children. Discontinue use if it changes smell, color or texture.

Lavender Chamomile Emulsified Scrub

Active time 15 min active, no cook time

Batch size about 8 oz (225 g)

Ingredients

INGREDIENT	AMOUNT
Emulsifying wax NF	15 g (0.5 oz)
Sunflower oil	60 g (2.1 oz)
Distilled water	40 g (1.4 oz)
White granulated sugar	100 g (3.5 oz)
Broad-spectrum preservative (per its own label)	per label — typically 0.5-1 g
Lavender essential oil	15 drops
Roman chamomile essential oil	8 drops

Method

- 1 Set up a double boiler and melt the emulsifying wax and sunflower oil together until clear (about 5 min).
- 2 Warm the distilled water separately to about 160-170°F (70-77°C).
- 3 Pour the warm water into the oil mixture in a thin stream, stirring constantly, until creamy.
- 4 Cool the base to under 110°F (43°C).
- 5 Stir in the preservative at the label's stated rate, then the lavender and chamomile essential oils.
- 6 Fold in the sugar once the base is thick enough to hold it.

7

Spoon into a jar and label with the date made.

Shelf life

3 months at room temperature, needs a preservative. This recipe contains water, so it needs a broad-spectrum preservative (see ingredients). Without the correct preservative at the correct dose, it can grow mold or bacteria within days — never skip it.

Tips

- This calming blend is a good bedtime or after-bath scrub — the scent is meant to be soft, not sharp.
- If you want a stronger floral note, add lavender in 5-drop increments and test before going higher.

Before you make this

This scrub contains water and must be preserved correctly, used within its stated shelf life, and kept out of reach of children. Chamomile is related to ragweed — if you have a ragweed allergy, patch test before using this blend. Discontinue if it changes smell, color or texture.

Activated Charcoal Tea Tree Emulsified Scrub

Active time 15 min active, no cook time

Batch size about 8 oz (225 g)

Ingredients

INGREDIENT	AMOUNT
Emulsifying wax NF	15 g (0.5 oz)
Grapeseed oil	60 g (2.1 oz)
Distilled water	40 g (1.4 oz)
White granulated sugar	95 g (3.4 oz)
Activated charcoal powder (cosmetic grade)	5 g (about 1 tsp) — a little goes a long way
Broad-spectrum preservative (per its own label)	per label — typically 0.5-1 g
Tea tree essential oil	12 drops

Method

- 1 Set up a double boiler and melt the emulsifying wax and grapeseed oil together until clear (about 5 min).
- 2 Warm the distilled water separately to about 160-170°F (70-77°C).
- 3 Pour the warm water into the oil mixture in a thin stream, stirring constantly, until creamy.
- 4 Cool the base to under 110°F (43°C).
- 5 Stir in the preservative at the label's stated rate, then the tea tree essential oil.

- 6 Whisk in the activated charcoal until the color is even and there are no dark streaks.
- 7 Fold in the sugar once the base is thick enough to hold it.
- 8 Spoon into a jar and label with the date made.

Shelf life

3 months at room temperature, needs a preservative. This recipe contains water, so it needs a broad-spectrum preservative (see ingredients). Without the correct preservative at the correct dose, it can grow mold or bacteria within days — never skip it.

Tips

- Use a dark towel the first few times — activated charcoal can temporarily tint light-colored towels and tub surfaces.
- Keep the charcoal amount small: more doesn't clean better, it just makes rinsing messier.

Before you make this

This scrub contains water and must be preserved correctly, used within its stated shelf life, and kept out of reach of children. Tea tree oil can irritate sensitive skin — patch test before full use. Discontinue if it changes smell, color or texture.

Pink Salt & Sugar Grapefruit Emulsified Scrub

Active time 15 min active, no cook time

Batch size about 8 oz (225 g)

Ingredients

INGREDIENT	AMOUNT
Emulsifying wax NF	15 g (0.5 oz)
Sweet almond oil	60 g (2.1 oz)
Distilled water	40 g (1.4 oz)
White granulated sugar	50 g (1.8 oz)
Fine pink Himalayan salt	50 g (1.8 oz)
Broad-spectrum preservative (per its own label)	per label — typically 0.5-1 g
Grapefruit essential oil (cold-pressed)	15 drops

Method

- 1 Set up a double boiler and melt the emulsifying wax and almond oil together until clear (about 5 min).
- 2 Warm the distilled water separately to about 160-170°F (70-77°C).
- 3 Pour the warm water into the oil mixture in a thin stream, stirring constantly, until creamy.
- 4 Cool the base to under 110°F (43°C).
- 5 Stir in the preservative at the label's stated rate, then the grapefruit essential oil.

6 Fold in the sugar and pink salt together once the base is thick enough to hold them.

7 Spoon into a jar and label with the date made.

Shelf life

3 months at room temperature, needs a preservative. This recipe contains water, so it needs a broad-spectrum preservative (see ingredients). Without the correct preservative at the correct dose, it can grow mold or bacteria within days — never skip it.

Tips

- Combining sugar and fine salt gives two slightly different textures in one scrub — sugar dissolves softer, salt stays a bit grittier.
- Because this recipe contains water, the salt will soften faster than it would in an anhydrous scrub — use it within the stated shelf life for the best texture.

Before you make this

This scrub contains water and must be preserved correctly, used within its stated shelf life, and kept out of reach of children. Cold-pressed grapefruit oil can increase sun sensitivity — avoid direct sun on treated skin for about 12 hours after use. Discontinue if it changes smell, color or texture.

Peppermint Mocha Holiday Emulsified Scrub

Active time 15 min active, no cook time

Batch size about 8 oz (225 g)

Ingredients

INGREDIENT	AMOUNT
Emulsifying wax NF	15 g (0.5 oz)
Sweet almond oil	60 g (2.1 oz)
Distilled water	40 g (1.4 oz)
Light brown sugar	90 g (3.2 oz)
Unsweetened cocoa powder	10 g (0.35 oz)
Broad-spectrum preservative (per its own label)	per label — typically 0.5-1 g
Peppermint essential oil	10 drops
Vanilla fragrance oil	1 g (about 1/4 tsp)

Method

- 1 Set up a double boiler and melt the emulsifying wax and almond oil together until clear (about 5 min).
- 2 Warm the distilled water separately to about 160-170°F (70-77°C).
- 3 Pour the warm water into the oil mixture in a thin stream, stirring constantly, until creamy.
- 4 Cool the base to under 110°F (43°C).
- 5 Stir in the preservative at the label's stated rate, then the peppermint and vanilla fragrance oils.

- 6 Whisk in the cocoa powder until the color is even.
- 7 Fold in the brown sugar once the base is thick enough to hold it.
- 8 Spoon into a jar — a clear glass jar shows off the mocha color nicely for gifting — and label with the date made.

Shelf life

3 months at room temperature, needs a preservative. This recipe contains water, so it needs a broad-spectrum preservative (see ingredients). Without the correct preservative at the correct dose, it can grow mold or bacteria within days — never skip it.

Tips

- Cocoa powder can settle a little at the bottom of the jar over time — give it a stir before each use.
- This one is a popular holiday gift scrub; pair it with a simple ribbon and a handwritten batch date.

Before you make this

This scrub contains water and must be preserved correctly, used within its stated shelf life, and kept out of reach of children. Discontinue use if it changes smell, color or texture.

Cucumber Melon Emulsified Scrub

Active time 15 min active, no cook time

Batch size about 8 oz (225 g)

Ingredients

INGREDIENT	AMOUNT
Emulsifying wax NF	15 g (0.5 oz)
Grapeseed oil	60 g (2.1 oz)
Distilled water	40 g (1.4 oz)
White granulated sugar	100 g (3.5 oz)
Broad-spectrum preservative (per its own label)	per label — typically 0.5-1 g
Cucumber melon fragrance oil (skin-safe cosmetic fragrance)	3 g (about 1/2 tsp)

Method

- 1 Set up a double boiler and melt the emulsifying wax and grapeseed oil together until clear (about 5 min).
- 2 Warm the distilled water separately to about 160-170°F (70-77°C).
- 3 Pour the warm water into the oil mixture in a thin stream, stirring constantly, until creamy.
- 4 Cool the base to under 110°F (43°C).
- 5 Stir in the preservative at the label's stated rate, then the cucumber melon fragrance oil.
- 6 Fold in the sugar once the base is thick enough to hold it.
- 7 Spoon into a jar and label with the date made.

Shelf life

3 months at room temperature, needs a preservative. This recipe contains water, so it needs a broad-spectrum preservative (see ingredients). Without the correct preservative at the correct dose, it can grow mold or bacteria within days — never skip it.

Tips

- This light, fresh scent works well as a summer batch — pair it with a pale green or blue jar label.
- If the scrub ever smells sour or off before its shelf-life date, stop using it and remake a fresh batch.

Before you make this

This scrub contains water and must be preserved correctly, used within its stated shelf life, and kept out of reach of children. Discontinue use if it changes smell, color or texture.

Next Step

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